

Subject Code	ENGL5044
Subject Title	Cultural Studies
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Exclusion: ENGL520
Objectives	This course focuses on developing an awareness of cultural studies as a way to gain insights into the core cultural meanings in contemporary social life. We will analyse cultural artifacts and media texts in order to understand the cultural assumptions embedded within them. More specifically, we will investigate how cultural artifacts and texts reflect power relations, political ideologies, and group identities. The subjects will involve reading seminal texts in cultural studies and learning cutting edge methods in the analysis of cultural artifacts and media texts
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - Offer well-thought definitions and critiques of concepts such as “power,” “hegemony,” “popular culture” and “media” - Understand the important role that popular culture and media play in society - Demonstrate the ability to critically examine and discuss cultural artifacts and media texts in terms of prevailing social and cultural assumptions - Analyse cultural artifacts and media texts with respect to political ideologies, power relations, and group identities
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	• Definitions of culture • High culture and pop culture • Methods for studying culture and media • Media technologies • Ideologies and hegemony • Identity and intergroup dynamics
Teaching/Learning Methodology	Lectures with a heavy dose of interactive discussions and examples from popular culture and current affairs; PPTs, handouts and web-based resource materials available.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b	c	d		
	1. In-class quiz	25%	✓	✓	✓			
	2. In-class presentation	25%		✓	✓	✓		
	3. In-class final exam	50%		✓	✓	✓		
	Total	100 %						
	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:							
	In-class quiz: Students will complete a series of multiple-choice and short-answer questions that test students’ understanding of crucial terminology and concepts from the class.							
	Presentation: The seminar presentation is a PowerPoint presentation showcasing students’ ability to apply theoretical concepts learned in class to the study of a specific cultural artifact or media text.							
	In-class final assessment: Students will utilize key concepts from the course to provide theoretically informed analysis to prompts about contemporary media texts. The in-class final assessment will allow students to independently demonstrate their holistic understanding of fundamental concepts from the course.							
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	▪ Lecture						39 Hrs.	
	▪ Seminar						0 Hrs.	
	Other student study effort:							
	▪ Preparation for seminars and lectures						42 Hrs.	
	▪ Preparation for assignments						39 Hrs.	
	Total student study effort						120 Hrs.	

Reading List and References	References
	Billig, M. (2005). <i>Banal nationalism</i>. Sage. Block, David, John Gray, and Marnie Holborow (2012). <i>Neoliberalism and applied linguistics</i>. Routledge. Bookman, S. (2013). Branded cosmopolitanisms: ‘Global’ coffee brands and the co-creation of ‘cosmopolitan cool’. <i>Cultural Sociology</i>, 7(1), 56-72. Curran, N. M. (2021). Neoliberalism from above and cosmopolitanism from below: A Korean-English Meetup group in the United States. <i>Communication, Culture, and Critique</i>, 14(1), 70-88. Daly, J. S. (2024). The static welfare claimant vs. the dynamic migrant: Contrasting figures of personhood in YouTube comments. <i>Journal of Language and Politics</i>. Hall, S. (1999). Encoding, decoding. In During, S. (Ed). <i>The cultural studies readers</i>. Routledge. pp. 507-517 Jenks, C. (2018). Meat, guns, and God: Expressions of nationalism in rural America. <i>Linguistic Landscape</i>, 4(1), 53-71. Stokes, J. (2021). <i>How to do media and culture studies</i>. Sage. 3rd edition Storey, J. (2010). <i>Cultural studies and the study of popular culture</i>. Edinburgh University Press. 3rd edition. Tomlinson, J. (2007). Cultural globalization. In Ritzer, G. (Ed.). <i>The Blackwell companion to globalization</i>. Blackwell. pp. 352-366 Van Dijk, T.A. (2000). New (s) racism: a discourse analytical approach. In Cottle, S. (Ed.). <i>Ethnic minorities media</i>. pp. 33-49. Open University Press Wang, J., & Curran, N. M. (2024). Competing for Views and Students: The Implications of Platformization for Online Language Teaching. <i>TESOL Quarterly</i>. Williams, R. (2014). Culture is ordinary. In McGuigan, J. (Ed.). <i>Raymond Williams on culture and society: Essential writings</i>. SAGE. pp. 1-18.